BOOKS ▼

Translating Worlds

Booker-shortlisted translator **Padma Viswanathan** on bringing Ana Paula Maia's literary world to English

ON EARTH AS IT IS BENEATH
by Ana Paula Maia
Translated by Padma Viswanathan
CHARCO PRESS
₹1,820; 106 pages



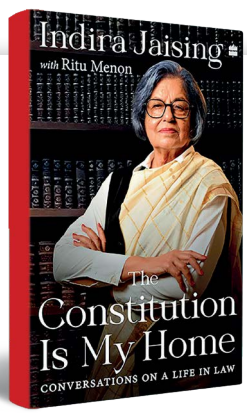


"TRANSLATION, FOR ME, IS A MATTER OF GOING DEEP INTO THE BOOK UNTIL YOU CAN'T TELL WHERE THE WRITING IS COMING FROM"

It's 7.30 in the morning in the southern US city of Fayetteville, Arkansas, where International Booker Prize nominee Padma Viswanathan lives. The 58-year-old writer-translator-educator wears many hats, between teaching creative writing at the University of Arkansas-Fayetteville and bringing stories in different languages to life in English. Brazilian writer Ana Paula Maia's Portuguese-language book *Assim na Terra como embaixo da Terra*, published in 2017, was on the Booker International shortlist for the English translation, *On Earth as it is Beneath* that Viswanathan worked on and published in 2025 (the winner, announced on May 19, was the Taiwanese novel *Taiwan Travelogue* by Yáng Shuāng-zǐ, translated into English by Lin King). It's not the easiest job to maintain the tonal integrity in such

THE LISTICLE

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THE CONSTITUTION IS MY HOME
By Indira Jaising with Ritu Menon
HARPERCOLLINS INDIA
Rs 699; 236 pages

A LIFE IN LAW

In a series of conversations with publisher and writer Ritu Menon, Indira Jaising looks back at an illustrious career in law, recounting some of her landmark cases as well as causes she has espoused. These include Mary Roy's uphill battle for equal inheritance, Rupan Deol Bajaj's fight for justice against sexual harassment, Shayara Bano's challenge to triple talaq, Jaising's advocacy for Bhopal Gas Tragedy victims and much more.

FLUID STATE

Through personal reflections and testimonies, this intersectional anthology pieces together a portrait of the LGBTQIA+ community's lived experience in India today. A joint effort between the Godrej DEI Lab and Westland, *Queer India Now* depicts experiences as disparate as a trans police officer's struggles at work, a lesbian couple's efforts to form a legal family and a gay man's mixed adventures in clubbing.

QUEER INDIA NOW
Edited by Dhamini Ratnam and Dhrubo Jyoti
QUEER DIRECTIONS
Rs 499; 272 pages

